Knowing What to Do—and Doing It

What does this situation call for from me?

READING

Epictetus, *Enchiridion* 30; Musonius Rufus, Lecture 5, "Which Is More Effective, Theory or Practice?" Relationships help identify responsibilities; Musonius puts practice ahead of explanation. An appropriate action is one you can reasonably justify. If obstructed, a different response may fit.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Announce on your Substack. Ask members to notice one responsibility they understand but find hard to carry out. Nobody needs a journal or prior lessons.

Open · 10	Read · 10	Discuss · 45	Practice · 15	Close · 10
Optional February observation	Aloud, together	The questions below	Give a virtue an action	One practice to retain

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

1. In an ordinary responsibility, what makes an action fitting rather than merely convenient?
2. How does being a friend, colleague, parent, or neighbor clarify your part?
3. When someone else fails in their role, what changes about yours?
4. If your plan is blocked, what concrete action could express the virtue now required?
5. Looking across judgment, desire, and action, what small practice is worth retaining?

PRACTICE THIS MONTH

Give it an action. Choose one recurring responsibility. Identify what matters, decide **"I will ___ because ___,"** and take the next step. Repeat when it recurs; adapt when circumstances change. Assess your reasons and follow-through, not others' cooperation.

FACILITATOR'S MOVE

"What would that look like?" Turn "be patient" or "be responsible" into conduct someone could describe. A useful answer may include a refusal or boundary.

NOTES